D.J. PARIS

# "I'LL LET YOU KNOW IF ANYTHING COMES UP."

That sentence just told your client they're on their own.

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# IF YOUR BUYER IS THE ONE TEXTING YOU FOR UPDATES, YOU BUILT THAT.

The passive promise sounds proactive. It's the opposite.

03 / 05

# A VAGUE PROMISE TURNS YOUR CLIENT INTO AN UNPAID PROJECT MANAGER.

The moment you say "I'll let you know if anything comes up," the client stops waiting and starts chasing: any word from the inspector, did the appraisal come in, what's happening with the survey. They hired you to carry that, not to monitor it from the outside. The fix isn't a warmer version of the same promise. It's a schedule specific enough that they never have to ask.

# REPLACE THE PROMISE WITH A SCHEDULE:

1 **Set a standing day and time.**

"Every Friday by noon, you get a status update, even if nothing changed."

2 **Promise the exception separately.**

"Anything material, you hear it from me first, not on Friday."

3 **Name the goal out loud.**

The goal is that your client never has to type the words "any update?"

THE TAKEAWAY

# A SCHEDULE BEATS A PROMISE, EVERY TIME.

Say exactly when they'll hear from you. Then be early.

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